



Fiona Stanley Fremantle Hospitals Group

OFFICIAL

Procedure

Waitlisting for Older Adult Mental Health Admission

Reference #: FSFHG-MENH-PRO-0010

Scope

Site	Service/Department/Unit	Disciplines
Fremantle Hospital	Mental Health Service	Medical, Nursing, Allied Health

1. Introduction

This document defines the process for waitlisting an Older Adult Community Treatment Team (CTT) consumer for admission to the Older Adult Inpatient ward.

2. Terminology

Older Adult Mental Health Service	Provides inpatient and community-based assessment, care planning and treatment for older adults aged 65+ years of age (45+ for Aboriginal consumers who identify as older adults) experiencing or suspected to be experiencing a mental illness or disorder who are living at home or in a RACF within the FSFHG catchment.
ARDT Lead	The role of the Admission, Readmission, Discharge Transfer (ARDT) Lead is to filter referrals and accept or decline as appropriate.

3. Procedure

3.1. Waitlisting procedure

- The Care Coordinator, Registrar or Medical Officer will identify the community consumer as requiring an inpatient admission and discuss the potential referral with the ARDT Lead regarding suitability.

- The ARDT Lead will review the case and discuss the suitability of the referral with the inpatient Consultant and provide the referring team with an outcome.
- The referring clinician will then:
 - enter the consumers details on Electronic Bed Management (EBM).
 - complete a Mental Health Assessment form and Risk Assessment and Management Plan
- The Older Adult CTT Triage Officer will liaise with the ARDT Lead regarding bed availability and length of wait time and feedback to the team at the Daily Intake meeting (DIM)
- Until an inpatient bed is available the patient's Care Coordinator will assess the need for interim interventions including regular risk assessment, intensive support including daily review and feedback to the DIM.
- All interim measures will be documented in the consumer's medical record.

3.2. FH catchment patient – requiring out of area admission.

- Where an inpatient bed is not available within five days of request the Care Coordinator and treating team will determine if admission to an Older Adult Mental Health bed in another catchment area is required:
 - The Older Adult CTT Triage Officer will liaise with the Bed Flow Coordinator to discuss waitlisting and availability of an out of area bed.
 - The Care Coordinator will contact the consumer and/or carer to discuss the possibility of an out of area admission including:
 - the indications for transfer
 - anticipated time frame
 - possibility of transfer back to Fremantle Hospital when a bed is available.
- When an inpatient bed becomes available at another service the ARDT Lead will inform the Care Coordinator of the following:
 - accepting hospital
 - ward
 - name and contact details of the accepting hospitals Treating Team
- The Care Coordinator will make contact to provide clinical handover and arrange admission.
- If at any point during the process the consumer is assessed as no longer requiring an inpatient admission this will be discussed with the Older Adult CTT Consultant Psychiatrist documenting the decision in the consumer's medical record.

- The Care Coordinator will inform the ARDT Lead, document decision and remove the bed request from EBM.

3.3. Out of catchment patients seeking FH admission

- The ARDT Lead will review the referral and discuss suitability with the inpatient consultant.
- Where the consultant declines the referral the ARDT Lead will advise the referring team of the decision and rationale.
- The ARDT Lead will keep the ward W4.3 Nurse Unit Manager (NUM) informed of pending referrals and any barriers to admission.
- When a bed is available the Clinical Nurse Specialist (CNS) from the referring service will be informed and advised to contact the W4.3 NUM/CNS to provide clinical handover.

4. Compliance/performance monitoring

- Wait times for an inpatient admission to the Older Adult Mental Health ward (W4.3) will be monitored by the NUM and a report made available to the FOAMHS team on request.

5. Related policy documents

- SMHS:
 - [Mental Health Bed Access, Capacity and Escalation \(State-wide Policy\)](#) (Place card)
 - [Care Coordination in mental health](#) (SMHS: 13)
- FSFHG:
 - Clinical handover
 - Clinical documentation
 - Clinical risk assessment and management

6. Related standards

- NSQHS Standards:
 - Clinical Governance
 - Partnering with Consumers
 - Communicating for Safety
- Chief Psychiatrist Standards for Clinical Care:

- Assessment
- Care planning
- Risk assessment and management
- Transfer of care

7. Authorisation

EXECUTIVE SPONSOR: Service Director, Service 5					
Version	Date Issued	Compiled/Revised By	Committee/Consumer Group Consulted	Endorsed By	Revision due
1	03/2016	CNS, FOAMHS	MHS CGC	FH Policy Committee	03/2020
2	12/2020	CNS, FOAMHS	Service 5 SQR Committee	FSFHG Policy Committee	12/2024
3	12/2024	NUM Ward W4.3		Service 5 SQR Committee	05/2029
4	01/2026	FSFHG Policy Team Minor template update only		FSFHG Policy Committee	05/2029